

TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86MOSCOW018493

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ACTION EUR-00

INFO LOG-00 COPY-01 ADS-00 INR-10 SS-00 CIAE-00 DODE-00
H-01 NSCE-00 NSAE-00 HA-09 L-03 PM-10 PA-01
OMB-01 ACDA-12 SP-02 SNP-01 PRS-01 SARN-01 SDEL-03
SART-01 /057 W

P 241615Z OCT 86
FM AMEMBASSY MOSCOW
TO SECSTATE WASHDC PRIORITY 2230
INFO MOSCOW POLITICAL COLLECTIVE
USIA WASHDC 6495
AMEMBASSY BRUSSELS
AMEMBASSY THE HAGUE

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E.O. 12356: DECL: OADR
TAGS: PARM, PROP, UR
SUBJECT: SOVIET PUBLIC LINE ON REYKJAVIK

REFS: (A) MOSCOW 18038 (B) MOSCOW 18082

1. CONFIDENTIAL - ENTIRE TEXT.

SUMMARY

2. TWO WEEKS AFTER REYKJAVIK, THE SOVIET PUBLIC CAMPAIGN IS PRESSING AHEAD AT FULL SPEED. THE SOVIETS HAVE RECOVERED FROM THEIR EARLIER CONFUSION ON LINKAGE, BUT THE LINE ON THE NATURE OF THE SOVIET DEMAND WITH REGARD TO SDI REMAINS INCONSISTENT. THE SOVIETS CONTINUE TO INSIST THAT U.S. SPOKESMEN HAVE DISTORTED SEVERAL ASPECTS OF REYKJAVIK.

END SUMMARY

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THE PUBLIC CAMPAIGN

3. TWO WEEKS AFTER REYKJAVIK, THE SOVIET PUBLIC PRESS ON REYKJAVIK IS IN FULL SWING. IN ADDITION TO THE EXPECTED ARRAY OF ARTICLES, COMMENTARIES, AND OTHER REPORTS OF SUPPORT FOR THE SOVIET POSITION, THE MEDIA CAMPAIGN HAS FEATURED THREE MAJOR TELEVISION APPEARANCES BY GORBACHEV. THE LAST OF THESE, WE SUSPECT, WAS PROMPTED BY FRUSTRATION -- ONLY THINLY

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EXCISE

DEPARTMENT OF STATE

APPEALS REVIEW PANEL, DATE

() RELEASE () EXCISE () DENY

() Non-responsive information

FOIA Exemptions (s)

PA Exemption (s)

Classification Review By

() DECLASSIFY

() DECLASSIFY IN PART

() RETAIN CLASSIFICATION (a) 3.5

() CLASSIFY AS OADR

() DOWNGRADE TO () S, () C, OADR

DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/GDC/MR

REVIEWED BY

DATE 11/16/89

() RELEASE () DECLASSIFY

() EXCISE () DECLASSIFY IN PART

() DENY () Non-responsive info.

FOIA Exemptions (s) b1, b3, b5

PA Exemption (s) b1, b3, b5

Authority to: OADR

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DISGUISED IN GORBACHEV'S OCTOBER 22 SPEECH -- THAT THERE HAS NOT BEEN MORE SUPPORT IN THE WEST FOR SOVIET PROPOSALS, MORE PRESSURE ON WASHINGTON TO CHANGE ITS STANCE ON SOI, AND THAT ADMINISTRATION SPOKESMEN ALLEGEDLY DISTORT THE REYKJAVIK RECORD.

PRINCIPAL THEMES

4. THE SOVIET CAMPAIGN IS BUILT UPON SEVERAL PRINCIPAL THEMES:

--AN "HISTORICAL" OPPORTUNITY FOR A BREAKTHROUGH ON ARMS CONTROL WAS MISSED IN REYKJAVIK DUE TO THE AMERICANS' STUBBORN INSISTENCE ON SOI, WHICH IS NOW THE MAIN OBSTACLE TO NUCLEAR DISARMAMENT;

--THE SOVIET SIDE CAME TO ICELAND WITH NEW PROPOSALS AND MADE IMPORTANT CONCESSIONS (INCLUDING AGREEING TO PERMIT SOI RESEARCH), WHILE THE U.S. CAME WITH "EMPTY HANDS";

--"MILITARIST" CIRCLES IN THE WEST, NOT WANTING AN END TO THE ARMS RACE, ARE SEEKING TO DERAIL THE PROCESS SET IN MOTION BY REYKJAVIK;

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--U.S. SPOKESMEN ARE DISTORTING, FOR THEIR OWN ENDS, WHAT TRANSPIRED AND WHAT WAS AGREED AT THE MEETING; AND

--THE U.S. IS SEEKING TO CHANGE THE ABM TREATY WHILE THE USSR IS CALLING FOR ITS STRICT OBSERVANCE.

5. HAVING MADE SOME OR ALL OF THE ABOVE POINTS, THE VAST MAJORITY OF SOVIET COMMENTARIES HAVE ALSO BEEN CAREFUL TO NOTE THAT POSITIVE ACCOMPLISHMENTS WERE ACHIEVED AT REYKJAVIK; THAT THE ARMS CONTROL DIALOGUE IS NOW ON A "QUALITATIVELY" DIFFERENT LEVEL; AND THAT FURTHER PROGRESS IS POSSIBLE. VIRTUALLY EVERY ARTICLE THAT APPEARS IN THE SOVIET PRESS ON THE ICELAND MEETING -- NO MATTER HOW NEGATIVE IT MAY BE ON THE U.S. POSITION -- CONCLUDES WITH A NOTE OF OPTIMISM.

DIFFERENT INTERPRETATIONS OF REYKJAVIK

6. AS NOTED ABOVE, THE SOVIETS HAVE BEEN CHARGING USG SPOKESMEN WITH DISTORTING THE RECORD OF REYKJAVIK. AMONG THE DIFFERENT INTERPRETATIONS WHICH HAVE BEEN AIDED PUBLICLY ARE:

--WHETHER THE LEADERS AGREED TO ELIMINATE BALLISTIC MISSILES, ALL STRATEGIC OFFENSIVE NUCLEAR ARMS, OR ALL

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NUCLEAR WEAPONS;

--WHETHER SRINF LIMITS WOULD PERMIT THE U.S. TO MATCH
THE SOVIET LEVEL OR FREEZE EACH SIDE AT CURRENT
NUMBERS;

--WHETHER THE USSR OR U.S. SOUGHT CHANGES IN THE ABM

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OMB-01 ACOA-12 SP-02 SNP-01 PRS-01 SARN-01 SOEL-03
SART-01 /057 W

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P 241615Z OCT 86
FM AMEMBASSY MOSCOW
TO SECSTATE WASHDC PRIORITY 2231
INFO MOSCOW POLITICAL COLLECTIVE
USIA WASHDC 6496
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TREATY;

--WHETHER THE FIFTY PERCENT REDUCTION WOULD APPLY
TO STRATEGIC OFFENSIVE ARMS GENERALLY OR TO EACH LEG
OF THE STRATEGIC TRIAD; AND

--WHETHER GORBACHEV SPRUNG THE "PACKAGE" NATURE OF
SOVIET PROPOSALS AT THE END OF THE MEETINGS OR MADE IT
CLEAR SOONER.

DETAIL ON REYKJAVIK

7. DURING THE LAST TWO WEEKS, THE SOVIETS -- AND
PARTICULARLY GORBACHEV -- HAVE GONE INTO CONSIDERABLE
DETAIL ON THE DISCUSSIONS BETWEEN THE TWO LEADERS.
PRAVDA REPORTED THAT GORBACHEV TOLD VISITING DANISH
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PRIME MINISTER SCHLUETER THAT IT SEEMED NO LONGER
DESIRABLE TO PROTECT THE CONFIDENTIALITY OF TALKS WITH
THE U.S., GIVEN "THE UNPRECEDENTED DISTORTION" OF
EVENTS AT REYKJAVIK IN THE U.S. PRESS. (THIS DOES NOT
EXPLAIN, HOWEVER, WHY GORBACHEV FELT HE COULD GO
INTO SUCH PUBLIC DETAIL IN HIS OCTOBER 12 PRESS CON-
FERENCE OR OCTOBER 14 SPEECH.) WHAT THIS MEANS FOR
THE SOVIET APPROACH TO FUTURE CONFIDENTIAL EXCHANGES
REMAINS TO BE SEEN.

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LINKAGE

8. AFTER A WEEK OF CONTRADICTIONS AND CONFUSION ON THE ISSUE OF LINKAGE -- SPECIFICALLY, WHETHER AN INF AGREEMENT COULD BE CONCLUDED WITHOUT A SETTLEMENT OF THE SDI QUESTION -- THE SOVIETS APPEAR TO HAVE STRAIGHTENED OUT THEIR PUBLIC LINE. AT AN OCTOBER 17 PRESS CONFERENCE (REF A), SOVIET NEGOTIATOR KARPOV EXPLAINED THAT WORK COULD GO FORWARD SEPARATELY IN EACH OF THE THREE NEGOTIATING GROUPS, BUT ADOPTION OF AN AGREEMENT IN ANY ONE AREA WOULD HAVE TO BE CONSIDERED PART OF A PACKAGE. OTHER COMMENTATORS HAVE TAKEN UP THIS LINE (THOUGH, IN HIS OCTOBER 22 SPEECH, GORBACHEV EMPHASIZED ONLY THE PACKAGE NATURE OF THEIR REYKJAVIK PROPOSALS). HOWEVER, SOVIET SPOKESMEN HAVE YET TO COME UP WITH A PERSUASIVE RATIONALE FOR THE INF-SDI LINKAGE.

9. THE SOVIETS EVIDENTLY HAVE DECIDED TO RELINK INF TO SDI IN HOPES OF USING THE FORMER AS A LEVER FOR BRINGING ALLIED PRESSURE ON WASHINGTON. ALLOWING THE NEGOTIATION OF AN INF AGREEMENT AND HOLDING THINGS UP AT THE END WOULD PRESUMABLY SUIT SOVIET INTERESTS, AS A

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COMPLETED OR NEARLY COMPLETED ACCORD WOULD MAKE A BETTER LEVER. AT THE SAME TIME, WE DO NOT EXCLUDE THE POSSIBILITY THAT THE SOVIETS AT A FUTURE POINT MIGHT AGAIN RELINK INF; THE SOVIETS HAVE MADE SIMILAR ABOUT-FACES IN THE PAST. SUCH A SOVIET DECISION WOULD BE DRIVEN IN LARGE PART BY HOW MUCH OF AN IRRITANT AN AGREED BUT NOT IMPLEMENTED INF ACCORD BECAME IN SOVIET-WEST EUROPEAN AND SOVIET-JAPANESE RELATIONS -- AND PERHAPS IN SOVIET-EAST EUROPEAN RELATIONS AS WELL, GIVEN ROMANIA'S VIEWS WHICH MIGHT ALSO REFLECT THE UNSPOKEN FEELINGS OF SOME OTHER WARSAW PACT STATES

WHERE'S THE TEST BAN?

10. THE MORATORIUM AND PROPOSED COMPREHENSIVE TEST BAN -- WHICH DOMINATED SOVIET PUBLIC COMMENTARY ON ARMS CONTROL FROM AUGUST 18 UP TO JUST BEFORE REYKJAVIK -- SEEM NOW TO BE GETTING LIP SERVICE AS THE SOVIET MEDIA CAMPAIGN SHIFTS ITS AIM. THE SOVIETS OUTLINE REYKJAVIK PROPOSALS AS CONSISTING OF THREE PARTS: (1) START REDUCTIONS, (2) INF CUTS, AND (3) STRENGTHENING THE ABM TREATY REGIME AND NEGOTIATING A TEST BAN, BUT THE TEST BAN QUESTION HAS BEEN LARGELY OVERTAKEN BY THE FOCUS ON SDI AND THE ABM TREATY.

SDI RESEARCH

11. THE SOVIET PUBLIC LINE ON THEIR DEMANDS REGARDING
LIMITATIONS ON SOI HAS BEEN INCONSISTENT. SEVERAL
DIFFERENT PUBLIC CHARACTERIZATIONS OF THOSE DEMANDS
HAVE EMERGED TO DATE:

--IN HIS OCTOBER 14 SPEECH GORBACHEV CITED A DRAFT

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SOVIET PROPOSAL THAT IT WOULD BE "PROHIBITED TO TEST ALL SPACE ELEMENTS OF AN ABM DEFENSE, EXCEPT FOR RESEARCH AND TESTING CONDUCTED IN LABORATORIES." (IT IS UNCLEAR WHETHER GORBACHEV INTENDED "ELEMENTS" TO BE SYNONYMOUS WITH "COMPONENTS.")

--OVCHINNIKOV IN PRAVDA ON OCTOBER 17 AND OTHER COMMENTATORS WHO MAY HAVE A LESS EXPERT UNDERSTANDING OF THE ABM TREATY, HAVE DISCUSSED A MORE GENERAL BAN ON RESEARCH AND TESTING OUTSIDE OF THE LABORATORY.

--PSEUDONYM GEORGIYEV, WRITING IN PRAVDA ON OCTOBER 18, (REF B), APPEARED TO CALL ONLY FOR STRICT COMPLIANCE WITH THE ABM TREATY.

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--IN A ROUNDTABLE BROADCAST OCTOBER 19, GEN. CHERVOV
CHARACTERIZED THE SOVIET POSITION AS "SPACE TESTS OF ABM
COMPONENTS MUST BE BANNED UNDER ANY CIRCUMSTANCES."

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